LEARN · GRAMMAR

A1

Present Simple



The foundation of present simple: add **-s** for he/she/it, and use **do/does** for negatives and questions — never both at once.

★ Only one -s, ever

I / YOU / WE / THEY	HE / SHE / IT
base verb — no ending *I work*	**verb + -s / -es** *she works*
don't / do + base verb *I don't work · Do I work?*	**doesn't / does + base verb** *she doesn't work · Does she work?*
✗ **I doesn't understand.** ✓ **I don't understand.**	✗ **she doesn't works** ✓ **she doesn't work**

the -s marker moves to does/doesn't — it never stays on the verb too

1 Positive form

Add **-s** (or **-es**) to the verb for he/she/it. No ending for I/you/we/they.

-o, -ch, -sh, -ss, -x, -z → -es
go → goes · watch → watches

consonant + y → -ies
study → studies

- She **goes** to school every day.
- He **watches** TV after dinner.
- He **studies** English on Mondays.
- I **live** in Madrid.

2 Negatives and questions

Negative: **don't / doesn't + base verb**. Question: **Do / Does + subject + base verb?**

- He **doesn't like** coffee.
- **Does** she **speak** English?
- They **don't watch** TV in the morning.

3 Common mistakes

✗ He don't like coffee.	✓ **He doesn't like coffee.**	he/she/it needs "doesn't"
✗ Do she like music?	✓ **Does she like music?**	he/she/it needs "does"
✗ She doesn't goes to the gym.	✓ **She doesn't go to the gym.**	base verb after "doesn't", no -s
✗ I doesn't understand.	✓ **I don't understand.**	"I" needs "don't"
✗ She don't never eat meat.	✓ **She never eats meat.**	only one negative — don't combine "don't" and "never"

APPLY · PRACTICE

A1

Present Simple Practice

A Choose the correct word

1. She ___ to school every day. **(go / goes / going)**
2. ___ she speak English? **(Do / Does / Is)**
3. ___ you live near school? **(Do / Does / Are)**
4. We ___ lunch at 1pm every day. **(have / has / haves)**
5. He ___ three languages. **(speak / speaks / speaking)**
6. My sister ___ English and French. **(study / studies / studys)**

B Complete with the verb in brackets

1. My father ___ (work) in a bank.
2. He ___ (not / watch) TV before bed.
3. He ___ (study) English on Mondays.
4. We ___ (not / live) in London.
5. ___ (do) your brother play football?
6. ___ (do) you drink coffee? No, I ___ (not) drink coffee.

C Find and fix the mistake

1. She work in a hospital.

   _____

2. Does he plays tennis?

   _____

3. My father don't smoke.

   _____

4. She catch the bus every morning.

   _____

5. Does they live near you?

   _____

6. He always are late.

   _____

D Make it negative, then a question

1. she / drink / coffee every morning

   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____

2. you / like / spicy food

   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____

3. we / watch / TV after dinner

   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____

4. the shop / open / at nine

   NEGATIVE _____ QUESTION _____

E Speak

say it out loud with a partner

1. Say what time you wake up, eat breakfast, and go to school/work.
2. Say three things your best friend does every day. Use "he/she + verb".
3. Use "always", "usually", and "never" in three present simple sentences.